CASE STUDIES

CASE STUDY – 1 WORKPLACE FAVORITISM AND EMPLOYEE DISTRESS AT DECCAN DIGITAL SOLUTIONS

INTRODUCTION

Workplace favouritism is an organisational concern in which supervisors or managers are perceived to provide preferential treatment to selected employees on the basis of personal preferences, informal relationships, or subjective considerations rather than objective performance-related criteria. Such practices may undermine perceptions of fairness, transparency, and merit-based decision-making, which are important for a healthy organisational climate.

Favouritism may be reflected in the unequal allocation of work assignments, biased performance evaluations, selective recognition, and differential access to resources or career-development opportunities. Whether intentional or unintentional, perceived preferential treatment can affect employees who believe that their contributions are not being evaluated fairly. From the perspective of organisational justice, these experiences may involve:

Distributive injustice: perceived unfairness in the allocation of outcomes, rewards, or opportunities.

Procedural injustice: perceived unfairness in the processes used to make decisions.

Interactional injustice: perceived lack of respect, dignity, or appropriate interpersonal treatment.

Employees who perceive favouritism may experience reduced self-esteem, feelings of rejection or inadequacy, frustration, diminished motivation and job satisfaction, and emotional withdrawal from the workplace. If these experiences persist, they may also affect team relationships, productivity, and employee retention. Addressing such concerns requires appropriate individual coping strategies as well as organisational measures that promote fair and transparent practices. The present case study examines the emotional and occupational concerns associated with perceived workplace favouritism and describes the counselling interventions used to strengthen the client's coping abilities and workplace engagement.

CASE DESCRIPTION

Mr. Karthik Reddy, a 27-year-old Software Support Executive at Deccan Digital Solutions, Hyderabad, sought counselling due to emotional distress, reduced work motivation, and dissatisfaction arising from his workplace experiences. He reported that his team leader appeared to provide preferential treatment to one of his colleagues. According to the client, this colleague was

regularly assigned comparatively easier tasks, received more flexible deadlines, was appreciated publicly, and was offered better project opportunities.

The client stated that he possessed similar qualifications and maintained a comparable level of work performance, but felt that his own efforts were not adequately acknowledged. Initially, he attempted to overlook these differences, assuming that they might be temporary. However, as he continued to observe what he considered to be a pattern of unequal treatment, he began interpreting the situation as favouritism.

The client subsequently reported feeling undervalued, experiencing reduced confidence in his abilities, losing motivation to perform, and feeling frustrated and disappointed. He also began limiting informal interactions at the workplace and communicating less with colleagues. Although he reported that his work performance remained stable, he felt that the situation was adversely affecting his emotional well-being and job satisfaction.

DEMOGRAPHIC DATA

• **Name:** Mr. Karthik Reddy

• **Age:** 27 years

• **Gender:** Male

• **Educational Qualification:** BCA (Bachelor of Computer Applications)

• **Occupation:** Software Support Executive

• **Organization:** Deccan Digital Solutions, Hyderabad

• **Income:** ₹38,000 per month

• **Marital Status:** Unmarried

• **Living Arrangement:** Lives with parents in Hyderabad

• **Siblings:** One sibling

• **Position in Family:** Younger son

• **Family Support:** Strong emotional support

• **Family Conflicts:** None reported

PRESENTING PROBLEM

The client reported feeling emotionally distressed and demotivated due to perceived favoritism by his supervisor.

Key Complaints:

• Feeling undervalued and ignored

• Reduced motivation and enthusiasm

• Workplace dissatisfaction

• Decreased confidence

• Emotional frustration

Date of Onset: Approximately 2 months ago

Precipitating Factors:

• Repeated preferential treatment toward colleague

• Unequal distribution of opportunities

• Lack of recognition for client's work

Duration: 2 months

Previous Counselling: No

Intensity: Mild to Moderate

INTERVIEW WITH FAMILY MEMBERS / SOCIAL RELATIONS

• **Family:** Supportive relationship with parents and sibling

• **Friends:** Maintains limited social circle; reduced workplace interaction

• **Colleagues:** Cordial but emotionally distant due to dissatisfaction

• **Education History:** Completed BCA successfully; hardworking and sincere

ONSET

The problem began when the supervisor consistently started favoring another employee in task allocation and recognition.

PRECIPITATING FACTORS

• Perceived favoritism by supervisor

• Lack of recognition

• Comparison with coworker

• Reduced communication with supervisor

DURATION

Recent (approximately 2 months)

MENTAL STATUS EXAMINATION (MSE)

• **Appearance:** Neatly dressed and well-groomed

• **Behaviour:** Cooperative and attentive

• **Speech:** Normal rate and tone

• **Mood:** Frustrated and disappointed

• **Affect:** Appropriate to situation

• **Thought Process:** Logical and goal-directed

• **Thought Content:** Concern about fairness and recognition

• **Perception:** No abnormalities

• **Insight:** Good

• **Judgment:** Intact

Clinical Impression: No psychological disorder; stress is situational and related to perceived organizational injustice.

COUNSELLING SESSIONS

SESSION 1

Duration: 60 minutes

Objective: To establish rapport, understand emotional distress and facilitate expression of feelings.

Session Details

The session began with rapport building and creating a safe, supportive and nonjudgmental environment. The client initially appeared hesitant but gradually opened up about his experiences. He expressed feelings of frustration, disappointment and confusion regarding the perceived favoritism. He stated that despite working sincerely, he felt overlooked and unrecognized. This led him to question his abilities and professional worth.

Emotional ventilation was encouraged, allowing the client to freely express his thoughts and feelings. The counsellor validated his emotions, acknowledging that perceived unfairness can significantly impact self-esteem and motivation.

Psychoeducation was provided on:

• Workplace dynamics and managerial bias

• Perception vs reality in organizational settings

• Concept of organizational justice

The counsellor helped the client understand that favoritism may not always reflect personal incompetence but could be influenced by external factors.

Cognitive restructuring techniques were introduced to challenge negative thoughts such as:

• “I am not good enough”

• “My work has no value”

Stress management techniques were also introduced:

• Deep breathing exercises

• Thought reframing

• Relaxation strategies

Techniques Used:

• Active listening

• Emotional ventilation

• Validation

• Psychoeducation

• Cognitive restructuring

• Relaxation training

Client Response: The client became more expressive and reported feeling emotionally relieved after sharing his concerns.

Observation: Client showed mild distress but good insight and motivation.

ACTION PLAN

• Maintain professional conduct

• Focus on quality of work

• Avoid excessive comparison

• Practice stress management techniques

• Observe workplace patterns objectively

SESSION 2

Duration: 60 minutes

Objective: To improve communication skills and enhance confidence.

Session Details

The session began with reviewing progress. The client reported slight improvement in emotional stability but continued dissatisfaction. The focus shifted to assertive communication.

The counsellor explained the difference between:

• Passive behavior

• Aggressive behavior

• Assertive behavior

The client was trained to:

• Express concerns respectfully

• Ask for feedback

• Communicate career expectations

Role-play exercises were conducted to practice:

• Talking to supervisor

• Asking for clarity on assignments

• Requesting constructive feedback

The importance of self-presentation and visibility at the workplace was emphasized. The counsellor also encouraged the client to:

• Document achievements

• Highlight contributions during meetings

• Engage more actively in team discussions

Techniques Used

• Assertiveness training

• Role-play

• Problem-solving

• Supportive counselling

Client Response: Client appeared more confident and willing to communicate.

Observation: Reduced frustration; improved engagement.

ACTION PLAN

• Practice assertive communication

• Seek feedback from supervisor

• Maintain record of achievements

• Improve workplace visibility

• Build professional relationships

SESSION 3

Duration: 60 minutes

Objective: To strengthen resilience, self-esteem and long-term career perspective.

Session Details

The session focused on strengthening emotional resilience and long-term thinking. The client reported improved confidence and better emotional control.

The counsellor emphasized:

• Self-worth independent of external validation

• Long-term career growth

• Skill development

The client was guided to:

• Focus on learning and improvement

• Avoid internalizing negative perceptions

• Maintain balanced thinking

Career planning was discussed, including:

• Skill enhancement

• Future opportunities

• Career mobility

Problem-solving strategies were introduced to handle future workplace challenges.

Techniques Used

• Cognitive restructuring

• Career counselling

• Problem-solving

• Reinforcement

Client Response: Client appeared motivated, confident and future-oriented.

Observation: Significant improvement in confidence and coping ability.

ACTION PLAN

• Continue skill development

• Maintain emotional balance

• Monitor workplace environment

• Explore career opportunities if needed

OVERALL OBSERVATION

Across the three sessions, the client demonstrated gradual improvement in emotional expression, confidence, and perceived ability to manage workplace concerns. The counselling process provided an opportunity to explore his feelings, examine negative interpretations, practise assertive communication, and identify constructive coping strategies. The client reported feeling more emotionally stable and better prepared to engage with workplace situations. These observations reflect the progress reported and noted during the brief counselling period; continued follow-up may be useful to assess whether the improvements are sustained.

RECOMMENDATIONS

Recommendations for the organisation

Establish transparent and consistent criteria for performance evaluation and work allocation.
Ensure equitable access to developmental assignments and career-growth opportunities.
Encourage open communication and provide appropriate channels for employees to raise concerns.
Provide leadership development or training on fair, respectful, and unbiased supervisory practices.
Promote organisational policies and practices that support procedural fairness and merit-based decisions.

Recommendations for the client

Continue focusing on professional growth and skill development.

Avoid unhelpful social comparison and evaluate progress using realistic, work-related criteria.

Use assertive and respectful communication when seeking feedback or clarification.

Continue practising stress-management and relaxation strategies.

Seek appropriate organisational support if concerns about unfair treatment persist.

ORGANISATIONAL BEHAVIOUR MODEL

Observed pattern described by the client: A perceived favouritism-based approach, characterised by informal influence and unequal treatment.

Recommended approach: A system-oriented organisational model that emphasises fairness, transparency, supportive relationships, and merit-based practices.

The recommended approach is intended to strengthen employee trust, participation, and a sense of organisational support.

CONCLUSION

This case study illustrates the emotional and occupational difficulties that may arise when an employee perceives favouritism and unequal treatment in the workplace. The client reported frustration, reduced motivation, diminished confidence, and dissatisfaction after observing what he considered to be preferential treatment towards a colleague. The counselling sessions focused on emotional expression, cognitive restructuring, stress management, assertive communication, and career-oriented problem-solving. By the end of the intervention, the client reported improved confidence and emotional control, along with a greater willingness to address workplace concerns constructively.

The case also highlights that individual counselling, while useful in strengthening coping skills, cannot by itself resolve organisational practices that may contribute to perceived injustice. Transparent decision-making, equitable opportunities, respectful leadership, and fair performance-management systems are therefore important for fostering a psychologically supportive work environment.

CASE STUDY – 2 WORKPLACE STRESS AND BURNOUT

INTRODUCTION

Workplace stress is a commonly encountered psychological concern in contemporary organisational settings. It may arise when the demands and pressures associated with a job exceed, or are perceived to exceed, an individual's available resources and capacity to cope effectively. When stress is prolonged and adequate coping or organisational support is unavailable, it may contribute to burnout, a work-related phenomenon characterised by emotional exhaustion, psychological distancing or cynicism towards work, and a reduced sense of professional efficacy.

Factors such as excessive workload, unrealistic deadlines, limited control over work-related demands, insufficient recognition, and difficulties in maintaining work–life balance may contribute to sustained occupational stress. From a psychological perspective, prolonged stress may be associated with anxiety, irritability, concentration difficulties, sleep disturbances, physical complaints, and reduced motivation. At the organisational level, it may adversely affect productivity, attendance, employee morale, and job satisfaction.

The present case study examines the occupational and psychological difficulties reported by a corporate employee experiencing sustained work-related stress and symptoms consistent with burnout. It also describes the counselling support provided to help the client identify stressors and develop adaptive coping strategies.

CASE DESCRIPTION

Ms. Ananya Sharma, a 28-year-old Marketing Executive at Synergy Brand Solutions, Hyderabad, reported experiencing considerable work-related stress due to an increased workload and demanding deadlines. She had been employed with the organisation for the preceding three years and described herself as initially motivated and productive in her role.

Over the previous few months, her workload had increased considerably owing to staff shortages and the addition of new responsibilities. She was expected to complete assignments within strict deadlines, attend frequent meetings, and manage multiple projects simultaneously.

Gradually, the client began experiencing mental and emotional exhaustion, irritability, and reduced interest in her work. She reported difficulty concentrating, frequent headaches, and disturbed sleep. She also described feeling emotionally depleted and increasingly disconnected from her occupational role.

Despite her continued efforts, she felt that her work was not receiving adequate appreciation, which further affected her motivation. The sustained work pressure had begun to interfere with both her personal and professional life.

DEMOGRAPHIC DATA

• **Name:** Ms. Ananya Sharma

• **Age:** 28 years

• **Gender:** Female

• **Educational Qualification:** MBA (Marketing)

• **Occupation:** Marketing Executive

• **Organization:** Synergy Brand Solutions, Hyderabad

• **Income:** ₹42,000 per month

• **Marital Status:** Unmarried

• **Location:** Hyderabad, Telangana

• **Living Arrangement:** Lives with parents

• **Siblings:** One younger brother

• **Family Conflicts:** None reported

• **Physical Illness in Family:** None reported

• **Family Support:** Moderate

PRESENTING PROBLEM

The client reported experiencing excessive stress, emotional exhaustion and reduced motivation at work.

Key Complaints:

• Constant fatigue and exhaustion

• Difficulty concentrating

• Irritability and mood changes

• Sleep disturbances

• Reduced job satisfaction

Date of Onset: Approximately 3–4 months ago

Precipitating Factors:

• Increased workload

• Tight deadlines

• Lack of recognition

• Poor work-life balance

Duration: 3–4 months

Previous Counselling: No

Intensity: Moderate

INTERVIEW WITH FAMILY MEMBERS / SOCIAL RELATIONS

• **Family:** Supportive but not fully aware of the severity of stress

• **Friends:** Limited social interaction due to workload

• **Colleagues:** Professional relationships but limited emotional support

• **Education History:** Completed MBA successfully; academically consistent and hardworking

ONSET

The problem had a gradual onset due to continuous work pressure and increased professional responsibilities.

PRECIPITATING FACTORS

• Excessive workload

• Unrealistic deadlines

• Lack of appreciation

• Poor work-life balance

DURATION

Ongoing for the past 3–4 months.

MENTAL STATUS EXAMINATION (MSE)

• **Appearance:** Tired but well-groomed

• **Behaviour:** Cooperative but fatigued

• **Speech:** Normal but slightly slow

• **Mood:** Stressed and exhausted

• **Affect:** Restricted

• **Thought Process:** Logical

• **Thought Content:** Work-related stress and dissatisfaction

• **Insight:** Good

• **Judgment:** Intact

Clinical Impression: Symptoms suggest work-related stress and burnout; no severe clinical disorder was observed.

COUNSELLING SESSIONS

SESSION 1
Objective:
To understand stressors and provide emotional support.

Session Details

Rapport was established and the client was encouraged to express her concerns. She reported feeling overwhelmed and emotionally exhausted.

Emotional ventilation was facilitated. Psychoeducation on stress and burnout was provided. The client was helped to identify key stressors and understand their impact on her emotional and occupational functioning.

Relaxation techniques such as deep breathing were introduced.

Techniques Used

• Active listening

• Emotional ventilation

• Psychoeducation

• Relaxation training

Client Response: Expressive and cooperative; reported feeling relieved after discussing her concerns.

ACTION PLAN

• Practice relaxation techniques daily

• Identify stress triggers

• Maintain a regular sleep routine

SESSION 2
Objective:
To develop coping strategies and improve work-life balance.

Session Details

The session focused on time management and prioritization skills. Cognitive restructuring was used to address negative and stressful thoughts related to work responsibilities.

Work-life balance strategies were discussed, including setting appropriate boundaries, taking regular breaks and prioritizing important tasks.

Techniques Used

• Cognitive restructuring

• Time management training

• Supportive counselling

Client Response: The client appeared more hopeful and motivated.

ACTION PLAN

• Use time management techniques

• Take regular breaks

• Set realistic and achievable goals

• Maintain appropriate boundaries between work and personal life

OVERALL OBSERVATION

The client demonstrated improved awareness of the factors contributing to her occupational stress and of the coping strategies available to her. Following the counselling sessions, she reported a slight reduction in perceived stress and showed greater understanding of the importance of maintaining work–life balance. The brief intervention focused on stress awareness and practical coping strategies. Continued follow-up would be useful to evaluate whether these changes are maintained and whether further support is required.

RECOMMENDATIONS

Recommendations for the organisation

Review workload allocation to reduce excessive and sustained work pressure.

Provide employee assistance or other appropriate employee-support programmes.

Promote policies and practices that support work–life balance.

Ensure a reasonable and equitable distribution of responsibilities among employees.

Encourage supportive communication between employees and supervisors.

Review deadline expectations and project planning in relation to available staffing and resources.

Recommendations for the client

Continue practising relaxation and stress-management techniques.

Maintain a regular and healthy daily routine.

Follow consistent sleep habits wherever possible.

Use time-management and task-prioritisation strategies.

Set appropriate boundaries between work and personal responsibilities.

Seek further professional support if stress, sleep difficulties, or physical complaints persist or worsen.

ORGANISATIONAL BEHAVIOUR MODEL

Current model (as described in the case): An autocratic or strongly task-oriented approach, characterised by emphasis on task completion and deadlines.

Recommended model: A supportive and system-oriented approach that recognises employee needs, encourages communication, distributes responsibilities reasonably, and promotes employee well-being.

A supportive organisational climate, together with clear work expectations and adequate resources, may help reduce avoidable occupational stress and strengthen employee engagement.

CONCLUSION

This case study highlights how sustained workplace demands may contribute to occupational stress and symptoms associated with burnout, with potential consequences for an employee's psychological well-being and job performance. The client's reported difficulties were associated with increased workload, demanding deadlines, perceived lack of recognition, and difficulties maintaining work–life balance.

The counselling sessions helped the client identify major stressors, understand their effects, and consider practical coping strategies, including relaxation, cognitive restructuring, time management, and task prioritisation. The client reported some relief and demonstrated greater awareness of the need for a healthier balance between professional and personal responsibilities.

The case also indicates that individual coping strategies should be supported by appropriate organisational measures. Reasonable workload allocation, realistic deadlines, supportive supervision, recognition of employee contributions, and access to employee-support services are important in promoting occupational well-being and reducing the risk of prolonged work-related stress.

CASE STUDY – 3 OCCUPATIONAL BURNOUT WITH SLEEP DISTURBANCE

INTRODUCTION

Occupational burnout is a condition that may develop when an individual experiences prolonged and unmanaged stress in the workplace. It is commonly associated with emotional exhaustion, mental fatigue, reduced enthusiasm towards work and a sense of decreased professional effectiveness. Burnout is more likely to occur when employees are continuously exposed to heavy workloads, demanding targets, limited recovery time and sustained performance expectations.

Sleep disturbance is frequently associated with prolonged occupational stress. Continuous thinking about work-related responsibilities may make it difficult for an individual to relax and fall asleep. Inadequate or interrupted sleep can further contribute to tiredness, irritability, poor concentration and reduced efficiency, thereby creating a cycle between workplace stress and sleep difficulties.

From a psychological perspective, persistent occupational stress combined with inadequate sleep can influence emotional regulation, attention, decision-making and interpersonal functioning. If these difficulties continue for a prolonged period, they may negatively affect both professional performance and personal wellbeing.

This case study describes an employee experiencing occupational burnout accompanied by sleep difficulties and examines the role of counselling in developing healthier coping strategies, improving sleep habits and restoring work-life balance.

CASE DESCRIPTION

Ms. **Neha Reddy**, a 30-year-old Software Engineer working at **Vertex Infotech Services, Hyderabad**, had been employed in the organization for approximately four years. During the initial period of her employment, she was able to manage her responsibilities effectively and maintained a positive attitude towards her work.

During the previous six months, the client was given additional responsibilities following changes in the project team. She was required to handle multiple assignments simultaneously, meet demanding project deadlines and remain available for occasional late-evening work. Gradually, she began experiencing persistent tiredness and reduced interest in her professional activities.

The client reported that she frequently continued thinking about pending work even after returning home. This made it difficult for her to relax before bedtime. She experienced difficulty falling asleep and occasionally woke during the night thinking about unfinished tasks or upcoming deadlines. As a result, she often felt tired and unrefreshed the following morning.

She also reported increased irritability, difficulty maintaining concentration and occasional headaches. Her work efficiency gradually declined, and she became concerned about making mistakes in important assignments. These concerns further increased her stress and made it difficult for her to disconnect from work.

Although the client was aware that she needed adequate rest, she felt reluctant to reduce her working hours because of the expectations associated with her role and concerns about meeting project requirements.

DEMOGRAPHIC DATA

• **Name:** Ms. Neha Reddy

• **Age:** 30 years

• **Gender:** Female

• **Educational Qualification:** B.Tech (Computer Science and Engineering)

• **Occupation:** Software Engineer

• **Organization:** Vertex Infotech Services, Hyderabad

• **Income:** ₹68,000 per month

• **Marital Status:** Unmarried

• **Living Arrangement:** Lives with a working roommate in a rented apartment

• **Siblings:** One younger brother

• **Family Conflicts:** None reported

• **Physical Illness in Family:** None reported

• **Family Support:** Supportive family with regular communication

PRESENTING PROBLEM

The client reported persistent occupational stress accompanied by emotional exhaustion and disturbed sleep. These difficulties were beginning to interfere with her concentration, energy levels and overall work satisfaction.

Key Complaints:

• Persistent tiredness during the day

• Difficulty initiating sleep

• Occasional waking during the night

• Feeling unrefreshed after sleep

• Reduced enthusiasm towards work

• Irritability and emotional fatigue

• Difficulty maintaining concentration

Date of Onset: Approximately 5–6 months ago

Precipitating Factors:

• Increased professional responsibilities

• Multiple projects handled simultaneously

• Extended working hours

• Continuous performance expectations

• Insufficient recovery time

Duration: Approximately 5–6 months

Previous Counselling: None

Intensity: Moderate

INTERVIEW WITH FAMILY MEMBERS / SOCIAL RELATIONS

• **Family:** Supportive and concerned about the client's increasing tiredness

• **Friends:** Social interaction has reduced due to work-related fatigue

• **Colleagues:** Maintains professional relationships but has limited informal interaction

• **Education History:** Completed B.Tech successfully; described as sincere and achievement-oriented

ONSET

The difficulties developed gradually following an increase in workload and professional responsibilities. Sleep problems became more noticeable as work-related thoughts continued beyond working hours.

PRECIPITATING FACTORS

• Prolonged work-related stress

• Increased project responsibilities

• Limited rest and recovery

• Difficulty separating work from personal time

• Concern about meeting performance expectations

DURATION

Approximately 5–6 months.

MENTAL STATUS EXAMINATION (MSE)

• **Appearance:** Well-groomed but appeared tired

• **Behaviour:** Cooperative and appropriately engaged

• **Speech:** Normal in rate and coherent

• **Mood:** Stressed and fatigued

• **Affect:** Mildly constricted

• **Thought Process:** Logical and relevant

• **Thought Content:** Preoccupation with work responsibilities and performance

• **Perception:** No abnormalities reported

• **Insight:** Good

• **Judgment:** Intact

Clinical Impression: Occupational burnout symptoms associated with work-related stress and sleep disturbance; no severe psychological disorder was indicated during the internship assessment.

COUNSELLING SESSIONS

SESSION 1

Duration: 60 minutes

Objective:
To establish rapport, understand the client's occupational stress and explore the nature of her sleep difficulties.

Session Details

The session began with rapport building and the development of a supportive and non-judgmental environment. The client described feeling physically tired and mentally occupied by work responsibilities. She reported that thoughts about pending tasks frequently continued after working hours and interfered with her ability to relax.

The client was encouraged to express her accumulated frustration and emotional fatigue. Emotional ventilation and supportive listening were used to help her identify the relationship between workplace pressure, evening rumination and poor sleep.

Psychoeducation was provided regarding:

• Nature and common signs of occupational burnout

• Relationship between prolonged stress and sleep difficulties

• Importance of adequate rest and recovery

• Impact of continuous work-related rumination on sleep

Basic sleep hygiene strategies were introduced, including:

• Maintaining a consistent bedtime and waking time

• Reducing mobile and laptop use before sleep

• Creating a calm bedtime routine

• Avoiding work-related activities close to bedtime

Relaxation through controlled breathing was also introduced.

Techniques Used

• Rapport building

• Active listening

• Emotional ventilation

• Psychoeducation

• Relaxation training

• Sleep hygiene education

Client Response: The client participated openly and reported feeling understood and relieved after discussing her concerns.

Observation: Noticeable fatigue and moderate work-related distress were observed.

ACTION PLAN

• Follow a consistent sleep schedule

• Reduce exposure to screens before bedtime

• Practice controlled breathing before sleep

• Maintain a simple sleep and stress record

• Avoid checking work-related messages immediately before bedtime

SESSION 2

Duration: 60 minutes

Objective:
To strengthen coping skills, improve management of work demands and establish healthier boundaries between professional and personal life.

Session Details

The client reported a slight improvement in her sleep routine but continued to experience stress during periods of heavy workload. The session therefore focused on identifying manageable work priorities and reducing unnecessary mental pressure.

The following areas were discussed:

• Prioritization of work responsibilities

• Planning tasks according to urgency

• Taking short recovery breaks

• Establishing reasonable work boundaries

Cognitive restructuring was used to examine thoughts related to excessive responsibility and fear of making mistakes. The client was encouraged to replace rigid expectations with more balanced and realistic perspectives.

The importance of maintaining activities outside work was also discussed. The client was encouraged to gradually reintroduce leisure activities and social interaction into her routine.

Problem-solving strategies were introduced to help her approach workload-related difficulties systematically.

Techniques Used

• Cognitive restructuring

• Time-management training

• Problem-solving

• Supportive counselling

• Behavioural planning

Client Response: The client demonstrated greater awareness of her stress patterns and expressed willingness to modify her daily routine.

Observation: Reduced emotional tension and improved participation were observed.

ACTION PLAN

• Prepare realistic daily work priorities

• Take short breaks during prolonged work periods

• Schedule time for leisure and personal activities

• Avoid carrying unnecessary work-related thoughts into bedtime

• Discuss workload concerns with the appropriate supervisor when necessary

SESSION 3

Duration: 60 minutes

Objective:
To strengthen coping resources, improve emotional resilience and develop strategies for maintaining long-term wellbeing.

Session Details

The client reported improved sleep quality and somewhat better energy levels. She stated that following a more consistent evening routine helped her reduce work-related thoughts before bedtime.

The session focused on maintaining the improvements and preventing recurrence of excessive stress.

The following areas were discussed:

• Maintaining healthy daily routines

• Developing sustainable coping strategies

• Recognizing early signs of burnout

• Maintaining boundaries between work and personal life

Self-care strategies were reinforced, including regular physical activity, relaxation exercises, adequate rest and engaging in personally meaningful activities.

The client was also encouraged to monitor changes in her stress and sleep patterns and seek additional professional support if difficulties became persistent or significantly worsened.

Techniques Used

• Supportive counselling

• Reinforcement

• Self-care planning

• Relaxation techniques

• Mindfulness-based strategies

Client Response: The client appeared more energetic, hopeful and confident in managing her daily responsibilities.

Observation: Improvement was observed in reported sleep quality, coping ability and emotional regulation.

ACTION PLAN

• Continue maintaining healthy sleep habits

• Preserve work-life boundaries

• Practice relaxation or mindfulness regularly

• Monitor early signs of excessive stress

• Continue engaging in physical and recreational activities

OVERALL OBSERVATION

The client demonstrated gradual improvement in her awareness of workplace stressors and coping strategies. Her sleep routine showed improvement, and she reported better energy levels and emotional control. The counselling sessions helped her identify the relationship between work-related stress, excessive mental preoccupation and sleep difficulties.

RECOMMENDATIONS

FOR ORGANIZATION:

• Review workload distribution among employees

• Encourage reasonable working hours

• Promote healthy work-life balance

• Provide employee wellbeing and stress-management initiatives

• Encourage supportive communication between supervisors and employees

• Consider flexible work arrangements where organizationally feasible

FOR CLIENT:

• Maintain regular sleep and wake timings

• Continue relaxation and stress-management practices

• Set realistic expectations regarding work performance

• Maintain appropriate boundaries between work and personal life

• Engage regularly in physical, recreational and social activities

• Seek professional support if sleep difficulties or occupational stress persist

ORGANIZATIONAL BEHAVIOR MODEL

• Current Model: High-Demand / Performance-Pressure Model

• Recommended Model: Employee Wellbeing and Supportive Work Model

CONCLUSION

This case study illustrates the relationship between prolonged occupational stress, burnout symptoms and disturbed sleep. The client's increased workload, extended work responsibilities and difficulty disengaging from work contributed to emotional exhaustion and problems with sleep.

Through counselling, the client developed greater awareness of her stress patterns and learned practical strategies related to sleep hygiene, relaxation, time management, cognitive restructuring and work-life balance. The improvement observed across the sessions highlights the importance of

both individual coping strategies and supportive organizational practices in promoting employee wellbeing and preventing prolonged occupational burnout.

CASE STUDY – 4 DIFFERING PERCEPTIONS AT DECCAN MANUFACTURING WORKS

INTRODUCTION

Workplace perception has an important influence on employee relationships, trust and the overall work environment. Employees do not always form opinions about others solely from their present behaviour. Previous experiences, social information, assumptions and stereotypes can influence how a person is viewed within an organization. When an employee continues to be judged primarily on the basis of past experiences rather than present behaviour, it may result in stigma, mistrust and social exclusion.

Labeling theory is particularly relevant to such situations. The theory explains how assigning a particular identity or label to an individual can influence the way others perceive and interact with that person. Once a negative label becomes associated with an employee, subsequent behaviour may also be interpreted through that label, even when there is insufficient evidence to support the assumption.

Employees who have experienced previous legal or social difficulties may face challenges in rebuilding their social identity after returning to regular employment. Negative perceptions can affect their confidence, workplace relationships, job satisfaction and sense of belonging. Continuous suspicion may also contribute to anxiety, emotional distress and fear regarding employment stability.

From an organizational perspective, decisions based on assumptions rather than objective evidence can weaken trust and fairness within the workplace. A supportive organization should maintain confidentiality, encourage objective evaluation and ensure that workplace concerns are addressed through appropriate procedures.

This case study examines how perceptions formed from an employee's past can influence workplace relationships and contribute to psychological distress, even when there is no direct evidence of present misconduct.

CASE DESCRIPTION

Mr. **Arjun Kumar**, a 26-year-old Warehouse Assistant working at **Deccan Manufacturing Works, Hyderabad**, had joined the organization following a period of personal and legal difficulties in his past. Since joining the organization, he had been making consistent efforts to establish himself as a responsible employee. He regularly reported to work on time, followed workplace instructions and maintained satisfactory relationships with his immediate supervisor and colleagues.

For the first few months, his work environment remained relatively comfortable. However, some coworkers later became aware of his previous legal history through informal discussions. Around the same period, a small amount of cash kept for routine workplace expenses was found to be missing.

Although there was no direct evidence connecting the client to the missing cash and the available workplace information did not establish his involvement, some coworkers began expressing suspicion because of his past. Informal comments and gossip gradually increased, and the client noticed that certain colleagues became more distant in their interactions with him.

The client felt that he was being judged according to his past rather than his present behaviour. He became increasingly worried about how others viewed him and whether the situation might affect his employment. Over time, this resulted in emotional distress, reduced confidence and a feeling of isolation within the workplace.

DEMOGRAPHIC DATA

• **Name:** Mr. Arjun Kumar

• **Age:** 26 years

• **Gender:** Male

• **Educational Qualification:** 10th Standard

• **Occupation:** Warehouse Assistant

• **Organization:** Deccan Manufacturing Works, Hyderabad

• **Income:** ₹22,000 per month

• **Marital Status:** Married

• **Living Arrangement:** Lives with spouse and parents

• **Siblings:** Two siblings

• **Position in Family:** Elder son

• **Family Conflicts:** None reported

• **Physical Illness in Family:** None reported

• **Family Support:** Strong and supportive

PRESENTING PROBLEM

The client reported emotional distress arising from negative perceptions and suspicion among some coworkers. He expressed feelings of embarrassment, anxiety and uncertainty regarding his position within the organization.

Key Complaints:

• Feeling judged because of past experiences

• Anxiety regarding workplace relationships

• Fear that the situation may affect employment

• Reduced social interaction with colleagues

• Decreased self-confidence

Date of Onset: Approximately 5 weeks ago

Precipitating Factors:

• Informal disclosure of past legal history

• Workplace cash-related incident

• Suspicion from coworkers

• Negative comments and social distancing

Duration: Approximately 5 weeks

Previous Counselling: None

Intensity: Mild to Moderate

INTERVIEW WITH FAMILY MEMBERS / SOCIAL RELATIONS

• **Family:** Maintains a supportive relationship with spouse and parents, who encourage him to focus on rebuilding his career and maintaining stability.

• **Friends:** Has a small group of friends and generally avoids discussing workplace difficulties in detail.

• **Colleagues:** Previously maintained cordial relationships; interaction became limited after coworkers became aware of his past.

• **Education History:** Studied up to 10th Standard and discontinued further education due to financial circumstances.

ONSET

The difficulty developed after some coworkers became aware of the client's previous legal history and subsequently connected it with a workplace incident involving missing cash.

PRECIPITATING FACTORS

• Disclosure of previous legal history

• Workplace cash-related incident

• Assumptions made by coworkers

• Reduced interpersonal trust

• Fear of being negatively evaluated

DURATION

Recent; approximately five weeks since the workplace incident and subsequent change in peer interactions.

MENTAL STATUS EXAMINATION (MSE)

• **Appearance:** Neatly dressed and appropriately groomed

• **Behaviour:** Cooperative but initially cautious

• **Speech:** Normal rate, tone and clarity

• **Mood:** Anxious and concerned

• **Affect:** Appropriate to the situation

• **Thought Process:** Logical and coherent

• **Thought Content:** Concern regarding workplace perception and employment security

• **Perception:** No abnormalities reported

• **Insight:** Good

• **Judgment:** Intact

Clinical Impression: Situational emotional distress associated with perceived workplace stigma and interpersonal mistrust; no severe psychological disorder was indicated during the assessment.

COUNSELLING SESSIONS

SESSION 1

Duration: 50 minutes

Objective:
To establish rapport, understand the client's emotional response and provide a safe environment for discussing workplace concerns.

Session Details

The session began with rapport building and establishing a supportive and non-judgmental environment. The client initially appeared cautious while discussing his situation but gradually became more comfortable.

He described feelings of embarrassment, frustration and disappointment after noticing a change in the behaviour of some coworkers. He explained that he had been making efforts to maintain a stable work life and felt discouraged when his present behaviour appeared to be judged through information about his past.

Emotional ventilation was encouraged to help the client express his concerns without fear of judgment. The counsellor acknowledged the emotional impact of being perceived negatively while maintaining a balanced and objective perspective.

Psychoeducation was provided regarding:

• Workplace stigma and social labeling

• Stereotyping and cognitive bias

• Difference between assumptions and objective evidence

• Importance of focusing on present behaviour

The client was encouraged to avoid confrontational responses and maintain professional conduct. Basic relaxation and thought-reframing strategies were introduced to help manage anxiety.

Techniques Used

• Active listening

• Emotional ventilation

• Validation

• Psychoeducation

• Cognitive restructuring

• Relaxation techniques

Client Response: The client became more comfortable and expressive during the session. He reported feeling relieved after discussing his concerns in a non-judgmental environment.

Observation: Mild situational anxiety and guardedness were observed initially, followed by improved openness.

ACTION PLAN

• Maintain calm and professional behaviour

• Avoid unnecessary confrontation with coworkers

• Continue consistent work performance

• Practice relaxation techniques

• Discuss concerns with the supervisor when appropriate

SESSION 2

Duration: 50 minutes

Objective:
To improve emotional resilience, strengthen communication skills and develop constructive ways of responding to workplace perceptions.

Session Details

The client reported some improvement in emotional stability but continued to worry about how coworkers perceived him. The session focused on developing confidence and appropriate communication strategies.

Assertiveness training was introduced, with emphasis on:

• Responding calmly during difficult interactions

• Understanding passive, aggressive and assertive communication

• Expressing concerns respectfully

• Avoiding unnecessary defensive responses

The client was encouraged to separate his present identity and behaviour from previous experiences. Discussion focused on rebuilding confidence through consistent actions, responsible conduct and healthy workplace relationships.

The importance of objective workplace procedures was also discussed. The client was encouraged to communicate through appropriate organizational channels rather than responding to informal accusations.

Strategies for developing positive workplace relationships and maintaining professional transparency were explored.

Techniques Used

• Assertiveness training

• Supportive counselling

• Problem-solving

• Cognitive restructuring

• Behavioural guidance

Client Response: The client appeared more confident and showed greater willingness to handle workplace interactions calmly.

Observation: Reduced anxiety and improved emotional stability were observed.

ACTION PLAN

• Use assertive communication when required

• Maintain professional transparency

• Continue consistent work performance

• Develop positive workplace relationships

• Approach the supervisor appropriately if concerns continue

• Continue relaxation and stress-management practices

OVERALL OBSERVATION

The client demonstrated good insight and willingness to improve his adjustment within the workplace. Counselling helped him understand the influence of social labeling and perception bias while encouraging him to focus on present behaviour and constructive coping strategies.

A gradual improvement was observed in his confidence and emotional regulation. No severe psychological difficulties were identified during the counselling process.

RECOMMENDATIONS

FOR ORGANIZATION:

• Maintain confidentiality regarding employees' personal backgrounds

• Address workplace concerns through objective procedures

• Avoid decisions based solely on assumptions or stereotypes

• Promote respectful and inclusive workplace interactions

• Provide awareness programmes on workplace bias and stigma

• Encourage employees to use appropriate grievance mechanisms

FOR CLIENT:

• Continue maintaining consistent work performance

• Avoid internalizing negative labels

• Practice emotional regulation techniques

• Maintain professional communication with colleagues

• Build supportive workplace relationships

• Use formal organizational channels if concerns persist

ORGANIZATIONAL BEHAVIOR MODEL

• Current Model: Custodial / Control-Oriented Model

• Recommended Model: Supportive / System Model

CONCLUSION

This case study demonstrates how workplace perceptions and social labeling can influence an employee's emotional wellbeing and sense of belonging. Although the client was not directly connected to the workplace cash incident, assumptions based on his previous history contributed to mistrust and social distancing among some coworkers.

The counselling sessions helped the client understand the psychological effects of labeling, manage his emotional reactions and develop more constructive communication and coping strategies. The case highlights the importance of objective decision-making, confidentiality, respectful workplace relationships and inclusive organizational practices in creating a psychologically supportive work environment.

CASE STUDY – 5 DISSATISFACTION WITH PERFORMANCE APPRAISAL

INTRODUCTION

Performance appraisal is an important organizational process used to review an employee's work performance, provide developmental feedback and make decisions related to recognition, compensation and career progression. When employees perceive the appraisal process as fair and transparent, it can contribute to motivation, job satisfaction and commitment towards the organization.

However, dissatisfaction may arise when employees feel that their performance has not been evaluated accurately or that the appraisal criteria were not clearly communicated. A perceived mismatch between an employee's efforts and the appraisal outcome may result in frustration, reduced motivation and negative attitudes towards the organization.

Psychologically, appraisal dissatisfaction may be influenced by expectations, social comparison, perceived inequity and the need for recognition. Such experiences can affect an employee's confidence, workplace relationships and willingness to participate actively in organizational activities.

This case study presents an employee experiencing dissatisfaction following an unexpected performance appraisal outcome and examines how counselling can support emotional adjustment, constructive communication and future-oriented career planning.

CASE DESCRIPTION

Mr. **Sandeep Rao**, a 31-year-old Assistant Manager working at **Synergy Business Services, Hyderabad**, had been employed in the organization for approximately four years. During this period, he had received positive feedback regarding his reliability, work quality and ability to manage assigned responsibilities.

During the most recent annual appraisal, however, the client received a performance rating that was lower than he had anticipated. The salary increment provided to him was also smaller than expected, and he was informed that he would not be considered for the promotion opportunity he had been expecting.

The client reported feeling disappointed and confused by the outcome. He believed that his additional responsibilities and contributions during the appraisal period had not been adequately reflected in the final rating. He also compared his outcome with those of certain colleagues whom he believed had received more favourable recognition.

Following the appraisal, he noticed a decline in his enthusiasm towards work. He became less interested in participating in team discussions and began questioning whether his efforts would contribute to future career growth within the organization. He also experienced increased frustration during interactions with management.

Despite these concerns, the client continued to complete his responsibilities. However, he reported that his level of emotional involvement and motivation had decreased considerably.

DEMOGRAPHIC DATA

• **Name:** Mr. Sandeep Rao

• **Age:** 31 years

• **Gender:** Male

• **Educational Qualification:** MBA (Human Resources)

• **Occupation:** Assistant Manager

• **Organization:** Synergy Business Services, Hyderabad

• **Income:** ₹58,000 per month

• **Marital Status:** Married

• **Living Arrangement:** Lives with spouse and one child

• **Siblings:** One younger sister

• **Family Conflicts:** None reported

• **Physical Illness in Family:** None reported

• **Family Support:** Supportive family

PRESENTING PROBLEM

The client reported emotional dissatisfaction and reduced motivation following an appraisal outcome that did not match his expectations.

Key Complaints:

• Feeling that his contributions were insufficiently recognized

• Disappointment regarding the appraisal rating

• Concerns about fairness in evaluation

• Reduced enthusiasm towards work

• Frustration during management interactions

• Uncertainty regarding future career progression

Date of Onset: Approximately one month ago, following the appraisal

Precipitating Factors:

• Unexpected performance rating

• Lower-than-anticipated salary increment

• Delayed promotion opportunity

• Comparison with colleagues

• Lack of clarity regarding evaluation criteria

Duration: Approximately 1 month

Previous Counselling: None

Intensity: Mild to Moderate

INTERVIEW WITH FAMILY MEMBERS / SOCIAL RELATIONS

• **Family:** Supportive; spouse observed increased frustration following the appraisal

• **Friends:** Maintains contact with close friends and occasionally discusses work-related concerns

• **Colleagues:** Maintains professional relationships but has become less socially involved with the team

• **Education History:** Completed MBA successfully and has demonstrated consistent professional performance

ONSET

The client's dissatisfaction developed shortly after receiving his annual performance appraisal results. The unexpected rating and limited salary increment contributed to increased frustration and disappointment.

PRECIPITATING FACTORS

• Unexpected appraisal outcome

• Perceived lack of recognition

• Unclear expectations regarding promotion

• Comparison with colleagues

• High personal expectations regarding career advancement

DURATION

Approximately one month, with dissatisfaction continuing at the time of assessment.

MENTAL STATUS EXAMINATION (MSE)

• **Appearance:** Well-groomed and appropriately dressed

• **Behaviour:** Cooperative but mildly tense

• **Speech:** Normal rate and tone

• **Mood:** Disappointed and frustrated

• **Affect:** Mildly constricted

• **Thought Process:** Logical and goal-directed

• **Thought Content:** Preoccupation with appraisal outcome and career progression

• **Perception:** No abnormalities reported

• **Insight:** Good

• **Judgment:** Intact

Clinical Impression: Situational stress associated with dissatisfaction regarding the performance appraisal and perceived organizational inequity; no severe psychological disorder was indicated.

COUNSELLING SESSIONS

SESSION 1
Duration: 60 minutes

Objective:
To understand the client's emotional response to the appraisal outcome and provide an opportunity for constructive emotional expression.

Session Details

The session began with rapport building and establishing a supportive environment. The client discussed his disappointment regarding the appraisal and expressed frustration that his additional responsibilities had not resulted in the recognition he expected.

He also described comparing his rating with those of colleagues, which contributed to feelings of unfairness and reduced motivation. Emotional ventilation was encouraged to help the client express his concerns openly.

The counsellor provided psychoeducation regarding:

• Purpose and limitations of performance appraisal systems

• Difference between personal expectations and organizational evaluation

• Role of perception and social comparison

• Importance of obtaining specific performance feedback

Cognitive restructuring was introduced to help the client examine negative thoughts such as, “My efforts are not valued here” and “There is no point in working harder.”

Relaxation strategies were also introduced to help manage frustration.

Techniques Used

• Active listening

• Emotional ventilation

• Validation

• Psychoeducation

• Cognitive restructuring

• Relaxation techniques

Client Response: The client became more relaxed and acknowledged that the appraisal outcome could be explored through further communication rather than immediate assumptions.

Observation: Moderate frustration was evident, with good insight and willingness to reflect.

ACTION PLAN

• Avoid making immediate career decisions while emotionally distressed

• Practice relaxation techniques

• Review personal achievements objectively

• Reduce excessive comparison with colleagues

• Identify specific areas where feedback is required

SESSION 2
Duration: 60 minutes

Objective:
To develop constructive coping strategies and improve the client's communication with management.

Session Details

The client reported that he had become more comfortable discussing the appraisal issue and was interested in understanding the reasons behind his rating.

The session focused on proactive approaches such as:

• Requesting specific performance feedback

• Clarifying expectations for the next appraisal cycle

• Identifying areas requiring improvement

• Discussing career-development opportunities

Assertive communication techniques were introduced to help the client approach his supervisor professionally without expressing anger or defensiveness.

The concept of a growth-oriented approach was discussed, encouraging the client to view feedback as information that could support future development rather than as a judgment of his overall professional worth.

Problem-solving strategies were used to identify practical steps related to professional development, including improving visibility of work contributions and setting measurable goals.

Techniques Used

• Assertiveness training

• Problem-solving

• Cognitive restructuring

• Supportive counselling

• Goal setting

Client Response: The client became more solution-oriented and expressed willingness to seek constructive feedback.

Observation: Emotional intensity had reduced and the client demonstrated improved clarity regarding possible next steps.

ACTION PLAN

• Schedule a feedback discussion with the supervisor

• Establish measurable professional goals

• Improve communication regarding work responsibilities

• Identify relevant skill-development areas

• Maintain a record of significant work contributions

SESSION 3
Duration: 60 minutes

Objective:
To strengthen emotional resilience and encourage balanced long-term career planning.

Session Details

The client reported improved emotional control and stated that he had discussed the appraisal outcome with his supervisor. The discussion provided greater clarity regarding expectations and areas requiring further development.

The session focused on:

• Managing expectations regarding career progression

• Developing resilience towards workplace setbacks

• Identifying realistic professional goals

• Evaluating long-term career satisfaction

The client was encouraged to distinguish between a temporary dissatisfaction with one appraisal cycle and broader concerns regarding career alignment.

Self-reflection was encouraged to help the client periodically evaluate his progress, workplace satisfaction and professional development.

Techniques Used

• Supportive counselling

• Self-reflection

• Reinforcement

• Problem-solving

• Goal setting

Client Response: The client appeared more confident and demonstrated a more balanced perspective towards the appraisal outcome.

Observation: Improved coping, reduced frustration and greater focus on future development were observed.

ACTION PLAN

• Continue working towards identified performance goals

• Maintain constructive communication with management

• Monitor job satisfaction periodically

• Continue professional skill development

• Reassess career plans based on future experiences and opportunities

OVERALL OBSERVATION

The client demonstrated gradual improvement in emotional regulation and developed a more balanced understanding of the appraisal outcome. Counselling helped him move from an immediate emotional reaction towards constructive communication, self-reflection and career planning.

He showed increased willingness to seek feedback and identify areas for professional development rather than focusing solely on the appraisal rating.

RECOMMENDATIONS

FOR ORGANIZATION:

• Clearly communicate appraisal criteria and expectations

• Provide timely and specific performance feedback

• Maintain consistency in evaluation procedures

• Reduce scope for personal bias in performance assessment

• Provide employees with opportunities to discuss appraisal outcomes

• Link performance feedback with meaningful development plans

FOR CLIENT:

• Focus on continuous skill development

• Maintain realistic expectations regarding career progression

• Communicate openly with management

• Avoid excessive comparison with colleagues

• Maintain records of professional achievements

• Develop flexibility in responding to workplace feedback

ORGANIZATIONAL BEHAVIOR MODEL

• **Current Model:** Subjective / Evaluation-Oriented Performance Management Model

• **Recommended Model:** Transparent and Development-Oriented Performance Management System

CONCLUSION

This case study illustrates how an unexpected performance appraisal outcome can influence an employee's motivation, job satisfaction and perception of organizational fairness. The client's disappointment was intensified by comparison with colleagues and uncertainty regarding the reasons behind his appraisal result.

Through counselling, the client developed healthier ways of interpreting the situation, improved his communication approach and identified practical steps for professional development. The case highlights the importance of transparent appraisal criteria, constructive feedback, clear communication and employee development in maintaining a positive organizational environment.

CASE STUDY – 6 DIFFICULT TRANSITIONS

INTRODUCTION

Organizational transitions can have a considerable impact on an employee's psychological adjustment, professional identity and sense of security. Moving from one workplace environment to another often requires employees to adapt to new expectations, communication patterns, leadership styles and organizational practices. When the new environment differs considerably from what an employee has previously experienced, adjustment may become challenging.

Organizational culture consists of shared values, norms, practices and expectations that influence how employees behave and interact at work. A significant difference between an employee's expectations and the existing organizational culture may contribute to dissatisfaction, frustration and difficulty developing a sense of belonging.

From a psychological perspective, organizational transitions may result in role uncertainty, adjustment difficulties, interpersonal discomfort and emotional stress. Employees may compare their current workplace with their previous organization and experience difficulty accepting unfamiliar practices.

This case study describes an employee experiencing adjustment difficulties following a change in organizational environment and highlights the importance of adaptive coping, interpersonal adjustment, resilience and organizational support during workplace transitions.

CASE DESCRIPTION

Mr. **Rohit Varma**, a 32-year-old Administrative Coordinator, joined **Nexora Business Solutions, Hyderabad**, after his previous organization underwent restructuring and his position was discontinued.

In his previous workplace, the client had experienced a relatively flexible work environment where employees were encouraged to communicate directly with managers, participate in decision-making and take initiative in their responsibilities. He had developed comfortable professional relationships with colleagues and had become familiar with the organization's working style.

After joining the new organization, he encountered a more formal and hierarchical environment. Work approvals were required at multiple levels, procedures were closely followed and decision-making generally took longer than he had previously experienced.

Initially, the client attempted to adapt to the new system. However, he gradually became frustrated with the formal procedures and felt that his previous experience and suggestions were not being adequately utilized. He also found it difficult to develop close relationships with colleagues, who generally maintained formal and task-focused interactions.

The client began comparing his present workplace with his previous organization and reported a growing sense of dissatisfaction and disconnection. Although he continued to perform his assigned duties appropriately, he felt less enthusiastic about his role and uncertain about whether he could establish a long-term career in the new organization.

DEMOGRAPHIC DATA

• **Name:** Mr. Rohit Varma

• **Age:** 32 years

• **Gender:** Male

• **Educational Qualification:** MBA (Human Resources)

• **Occupation:** Administrative Coordinator

• **Organization:** Nexora Business Solutions, Hyderabad

• **Income:** ₹48,000 per month

• **Marital Status:** Married

• **Living Arrangement:** Lives with spouse and child

• **Siblings:** One younger brother

• **Position in Family:** Elder son

• **Family Conflicts:** None reported

• **Physical Illness in Family:** None reported

• **Family Support:** Strong emotional support from spouse and parents

PRESENTING PROBLEM

The client reported difficulty adjusting to the work culture and procedures of his new organization. He experienced dissatisfaction, frustration and a reduced sense of belonging within the workplace.

Key Complaints:

• Difficulty adapting to the new work environment

• Reduced job satisfaction

• Frustration with formal procedures

• Feeling that previous experience was underutilized

• Difficulty developing workplace relationships

• Uncertainty regarding long-term career adjustment

Date of Onset: Approximately 3 months ago

Precipitating Factors:

• Change from a flexible to a more structured work environment

• Differences in communication and decision-making practices

• Limited social interaction with colleagues

• Comparison with previous workplace

Duration: Approximately 2–3 months

Previous Counselling: None

Intensity: Mild to Moderate

INTERVIEW WITH FAMILY MEMBERS / SOCIAL RELATIONS

• **Family:** Maintains a stable and supportive relationship with spouse and parents.

• **Friends:** Continues to interact with close friends but discusses workplace concerns only occasionally.

• **Colleagues:** Professional and respectful interactions, but limited personal connection with team members.

• **Education History:** Completed MBA successfully and has several years of administrative and organizational work experience.

ONSET

The difficulties developed gradually after the client joined the new organization and encountered differences in workplace culture, communication practices and organizational procedures.

PRECIPITATING FACTORS

• Change in organizational culture

• Greater emphasis on formal procedures

• Limited interpersonal bonding

• Reduced autonomy compared with previous workplace

• Frequent comparison with previous employment

DURATION

Approximately 2–3 months, with ongoing adjustment difficulties.

MENTAL STATUS EXAMINATION (MSE)

• **Appearance:** Well-groomed and professionally dressed

• **Behaviour:** Cooperative and appropriately engaged

• **Speech:** Normal rate, tone and clarity

• **Mood:** Frustrated and mildly dissatisfied

• **Affect:** Mildly constricted but appropriate

• **Thought Process:** Logical and coherent

• **Thought Content:** Preoccupation with workplace adjustment and career satisfaction

• **Perception:** No abnormalities reported

• **Insight:** Good

• **Judgment:** Intact

Clinical Impression: Adjustment-related emotional distress associated with workplace transition and perceived organizational-cultural mismatch; no major psychological disorder was indicated.

COUNSELLING SESSIONS

SESSION 1
Duration: 60 minutes

Objective:
To establish rapport, understand the client's adjustment difficulties and provide an opportunity for emotional expression.

Session Details

The session began with rapport building and establishing a comfortable, supportive and non-judgmental environment. The client appeared somewhat frustrated but was cooperative and willing to discuss his experiences.

He described his previous workplace as relatively flexible and collaborative. He reported that he had been comfortable communicating with managers and colleagues and had considerable independence in completing his responsibilities.

In contrast, he described his current workplace as more formal, structured and procedure-oriented. He expressed frustration regarding multiple approval processes and difficulty developing informal relationships with colleagues.

Emotional ventilation was encouraged to allow the client to discuss feelings of disappointment, uncertainty and loss of familiarity. The counsellor validated his experience while helping him understand that adjustment to a new organizational environment generally requires time.

Psychoeducation was provided regarding:

• Differences in organizational culture

• Stages of workplace adjustment

• Organizational socialization

• Role of expectations in job satisfaction

Cognitive reframing was introduced to help the client reduce excessive comparison between his previous and current workplaces. Relaxation techniques were also introduced to manage frustration.

Techniques Used

• Active listening

• Emotional ventilation

• Validation

• Psychoeducation

• Cognitive restructuring

• Relaxation training

Client Response: The client became increasingly expressive and reported feeling relieved after discussing his concerns.

Observation: Mild frustration and dissatisfaction were observed; insight and motivation for adjustment were good.

ACTION PLAN

• Reduce constant comparison with previous workplace

• Identify positive aspects of the current role

• Initiate brief interactions with colleagues

• Practice relaxation techniques

• Identify personal and professional adjustment goals

SESSION 2
Duration: 60 minutes

Objective:
To develop adaptive coping strategies, improve workplace interaction and increase the client's confidence in handling organizational differences.

Session Details

The session began with a review of the client's progress. He reported some emotional improvement but continued to experience frustration with organizational procedures.

The discussion focused on developing flexibility and identifying practical ways to function effectively within the existing organizational structure.

Assertive communication was introduced to help the client:

• Express work-related concerns appropriately

• Communicate suggestions with confidence

• Interact professionally with supervisors

• Avoid unnecessary emotional reactions

Strategies for developing workplace relationships were discussed, including:

• Initiating brief conversations with colleagues

• Participating in team activities

• Offering assistance when appropriate

• Gradually developing professional trust

The concept of proactive coping was introduced. The client was encouraged to focus on areas within his control rather than becoming preoccupied with organizational practices that he could not immediately change.

Career planning was also explored, including:

• Current career expectations

• Professional development opportunities

• Long-term organizational fit

Problem-solving techniques were introduced to help the client manage procedural difficulties more effectively.

Techniques Used

• Assertiveness training

• Problem-solving

• Cognitive restructuring

• Supportive counselling

• Behavioural planning

Client Response: The client appeared more engaged and expressed willingness to make greater efforts towards workplace adjustment.

Observation: Improved clarity and moderate reduction in frustration were observed.

ACTION PLAN

• Develop professional relationships gradually

• Communicate concerns respectfully

• Increase patience with organizational procedures

• Participate in team activities

• Focus on professional skill development

• Evaluate career options objectively rather than emotionally

SESSION 3
Duration: 60 minutes

Objective:
To strengthen resilience, improve decision-making and support long-term adjustment to the organizational environment.

Session Details

The client reported improved emotional control and better interaction with several colleagues. He stated that he had become more familiar with organizational procedures and was less emotionally affected by differences from his previous workplace.

The session focused on consolidating the progress achieved during the previous sessions.

Key areas included:

• Maintaining long-term coping strategies

• Strengthening emotional resilience

• Improving workplace adjustment

• Evaluating long-term career satisfaction

The client was guided to differentiate between:

• Temporary adjustment-related discomfort

• Persistent dissatisfaction with the organizational environment

He was encouraged to maintain a balanced approach by continuing reasonable adaptation efforts while remaining aware of his long-term professional goals.

Self-reflection exercises were introduced to help him periodically assess his job satisfaction, workplace relationships and professional growth.

Techniques Used

• Problem-solving

• Supportive counselling

• Self-reflection

• Reinforcement

• Goal setting

Client Response: The client appeared more confident, emotionally balanced and comfortable discussing his future plans.

Observation: Noticeable improvement in coping ability, workplace adjustment and overall perspective.

ACTION PLAN

• Continue adaptive coping strategies

• Maintain professional relationships

• Monitor job satisfaction

• Continue skill development

• Review career goals periodically

• Consider alternative opportunities only after careful evaluation if adjustment remains difficult

OVERALL OBSERVATION

The client demonstrated good insight and willingness to adapt to the new organizational environment. Across the counselling sessions, his emotional distress reduced and his ability to manage workplace differences improved.

He became less focused on comparing his current organization with his previous workplace and showed greater willingness to build professional relationships and work within the existing organizational structure.

RECOMMENDATIONS

FOR ORGANIZATION:

• Encourage transparent communication

• Provide structured orientation for new employees

• Support interpersonal integration within teams

• Encourage constructive employee feedback

• Reduce unnecessary delays in routine procedures

• Promote a respectful and inclusive work environment

FOR CLIENT:

• Continue developing adaptability and resilience

• Strengthen professional networking

• Maintain consistent work performance

• Participate actively in team interactions

• Focus on personal and professional development

• Reassess career satisfaction periodically

ORGANIZATIONAL BEHAVIOR MODEL

• **Current Model:** Bureaucratic / Formal Structure Model

• **Recommended Model:** Supportive System Model (participative, transparent and employee-oriented)

CONCLUSION

This case study highlights the psychological challenges that can arise when employees transition from one organizational environment to another with significantly different workplace practices. The client experienced frustration, reduced job satisfaction and difficulty developing a sense of belonging after moving into a more formal and structured work environment.

Through counselling, the client developed greater awareness of his adjustment difficulties, learned adaptive coping strategies and improved his approach towards workplace relationships and organizational procedures. The case emphasizes that successful workplace transitions require both individual adaptability and organizational support, particularly through effective communication, employee orientation and an inclusive work environment.

CASE STUDY – 7 DISCRIMINATION AT WORKPLACE

INTRODUCTION

Workplace discrimination is an important organizational and psychological concern that can influence employee wellbeing, job satisfaction and professional relationships. Discrimination may occur when individuals are treated differently because of characteristics such as gender, age, marital status, background or other personal factors.

Although organizations increasingly emphasize equality and inclusion, stereotypes may still influence workplace decisions and interpersonal interactions. Gender and marital-status stereotypes can create assumptions about an employee's availability, commitment and ability to manage professional responsibilities.

From a psychological perspective, experiencing or witnessing discriminatory behaviour may contribute to emotional distress, anxiety, reduced confidence and concerns regarding career security. Employees may also become less willing to express their opinions or participate actively when they perceive the organizational environment as unfair.

From an organizational perspective, discriminatory practices can affect trust, employee morale, team relationships and organizational commitment. Fair policies, transparent decision-making and respectful leadership are important for creating an inclusive workplace.

This case study describes the experience of a female manager who experienced emotional distress after encountering a gender- and marital-status-based remark in a professional setting. The case focuses on the psychological impact of perceived discrimination and the importance of appropriate coping and organizational support.

CASE DESCRIPTION

Ms. **Priya Nair**, a 38-year-old Operations Manager working at **Aarohan Customer Services, Hyderabad**, reported emotional distress following a management discussion concerning recruitment and workforce planning.

During the meeting, a senior manager suggested that younger unmarried women should be preferred for certain positions because they would supposedly have fewer family-related responsibilities and greater flexibility with work schedules. The client perceived the statement as inappropriate and discriminatory because it implied that marital status could be used as a basis for judging professional commitment.

The client herself was a married working professional with several years of experience in the organization. She felt uncomfortable hearing the remark and became concerned about whether similar assumptions might influence future recruitment, performance evaluation or career-development decisions.

She initially attempted to ignore the incident, but continued thinking about it after the meeting. She felt disappointed that no one in the meeting openly questioned the statement. This increased her perception that employees might not have sufficient support when facing biased attitudes.

Over the following weeks, the client experienced increased worry regarding her professional future, occasional irritability and reduced confidence when expressing opinions during management discussions. She remained capable of performing her responsibilities, but reported increased emotional discomfort and preoccupation with fairness in the workplace.

DEMOGRAPHIC DATA

• **Name:** Ms. Priya Nair

• **Age:** 38 years

• **Gender:** Female

• **Educational Qualification:** MBA (Human Resources)

• **Occupation:** Operations Manager

• **Organization:** Aarohan Customer Services, Hyderabad

• **Income:** ₹72,000 per month

• **Marital Status:** Married

• **Living Arrangement:** Lives with spouse and one child

• **Siblings:** One younger sister

• **Position in Family:** Elder daughter

• **Family Conflicts:** None reported

• **Physical Illness in Family:** None reported

• **Family Support:** Strong emotional support from spouse and family

PRESENTING PROBLEM

The client reported emotional discomfort and anxiety after hearing a workplace statement that appeared to associate professional suitability with marital status.

Key Complaints:

• Feeling uncomfortable about perceived gender and marital-status bias

• Concern regarding fairness in career opportunities

• Increased worry about future professional growth

• Reduced confidence while expressing opinions

• Emotional frustration and disappointment

Date of Onset: Approximately 3 weeks ago

Precipitating Factor:

• Biased statement regarding recruitment preference for unmarried women

Duration: Approximately 3 weeks

Previous Counselling: No

Intensity: Mild to Moderate

INTERVIEW WITH FAMILY MEMBERS / SOCIAL RELATIONS

• **Family:** Maintains a supportive relationship with spouse and family members. Family provides emotional reassurance.

• **Friends:** Maintains a small but supportive social circle and occasionally discusses general work-related concerns with close friends.

• **Colleagues:** Maintains professional relationships but has become somewhat cautious during discussions involving organizational policies.

• **Education History:** Completed MBA successfully and has demonstrated consistent professional growth and managerial experience.

ONSET

The emotional difficulty began after the client heard a senior manager make a statement suggesting preference for unmarried women during a discussion related to recruitment.

PRECIPITATING FACTOR

The primary precipitating factor was the perception that marital status was being considered as an indicator of professional commitment and flexibility.

DURATION

Approximately three weeks, with emotional concerns continuing during the assessment.

MENTAL STATUS EXAMINATION (MSE)

• **Appearance:** Well-groomed and professionally dressed

• **Behaviour:** Cooperative and attentive

• **Speech:** Normal rate, tone and volume

• **Mood:** Concerned and mildly anxious

• **Affect:** Appropriate and mildly distressed

• **Thought Process:** Logical and goal-directed

• **Thought Content:** Concern regarding workplace fairness and career security

• **Perception:** No abnormalities reported

• **Insight:** Good; recognizes the connection between the workplace incident and her emotional response

• **Judgment:** Intact

Clinical Impression: Situational emotional distress associated with perceived workplace discrimination and concerns regarding organizational fairness; no severe psychological disorder was indicated.

COUNSELLING SESSIONS

SESSION 1

Duration: 50 minutes

Objective:
To establish rapport, understand the client's emotional response and provide a supportive environment for discussing the workplace incident.

Session Details

The session began with rapport building and establishing a safe and non-judgmental environment. The client was encouraged to describe the incident and its impact on her thoughts and feelings.

She expressed disappointment, frustration and concern regarding the possibility that marital status might influence professional decisions. She also discussed feeling uncomfortable because no one openly questioned the statement during the meeting.

Emotional ventilation was encouraged, allowing the client to express her concerns freely. The counsellor validated her emotional response while helping her distinguish between the specific incident and assumptions about future organizational decisions.

Psychoeducation was provided regarding:

• Workplace discrimination and stereotypes

• Gender-related organizational bias

• Impact of perceived unfairness on employee wellbeing

• Difference between individual experiences and broader organizational practices

Cognitive reframing was introduced to reduce self-doubt and help the client focus on her professional strengths and present performance.

Basic relaxation strategies, including controlled breathing, were introduced to manage emotional tension.

Techniques Used

• Active listening

• Emotional ventilation

• Validation

• Psychoeducation

• Cognitive restructuring

• Relaxation training

Client Response: The client was open and cooperative and reported feeling relieved after discussing the situation.

Observation: Mild emotional distress was present, but insight and judgment were intact.

ACTION PLAN

• Avoid repeatedly replaying the incident

• Continue maintaining professional performance

• Practice relaxation techniques

• Focus on evidence rather than assumptions about future outcomes

• Identify appropriate channels for raising concerns if similar incidents occur

SESSION 2

Duration: 50 minutes

Objective:
To strengthen confidence, develop assertive communication and identify constructive ways of responding to workplace concerns.

Session Details

The client reported some reduction in emotional distress after the previous session but continued to feel concerned about possible bias in future decisions.

The session focused on helping her regain a sense of control and identify appropriate workplace responses.

The discussion included:

• Organizational grievance mechanisms

• Workplace equality and inclusion policies

• Importance of maintaining records of relevant workplace incidents

• Distinguishing between assumptions and documented organizational actions

Assertiveness training was introduced to help the client:

• Express concerns respectfully

• Communicate her views confidently

• Respond appropriately to inappropriate workplace remarks

• Maintain professional boundaries

Problem-solving strategies were used to explore possible responses if similar incidents occurred in the future. The importance of documenting professional achievements and maintaining evidence of performance was also discussed.

The client was encouraged to maintain supportive professional relationships and avoid withdrawing from workplace interactions because of one negative experience.

Techniques Used

• Assertiveness training

• Psychoeducation

• Problem-solving

• Supportive counselling

• Cognitive restructuring

Client Response: The client appeared more confident and demonstrated greater clarity regarding constructive ways of responding to workplace concerns.

Observation: Reduced anxiety and improved confidence were observed.

ACTION PLAN

• Communicate concerns appropriately when necessary

• Maintain records of significant workplace incidents

• Continue documenting professional achievements

• Maintain positive professional relationships

• Use formal organizational channels if discriminatory behaviour continues

• Continue practicing stress-management techniques

OVERALL OBSERVATION

The client demonstrated good insight and emotional awareness throughout the counselling process. She gradually developed a more balanced perspective regarding the workplace incident and became more confident about responding constructively to future concerns.

Counselling helped reduce emotional distress and encouraged the client to focus on her professional strengths, appropriate communication and available organizational resources.

RECOMMENDATIONS

FOR ORGANIZATION:

• Establish clear non-discrimination and equal-opportunity policies

• Conduct gender-sensitivity and inclusion training

• Ensure recruitment decisions are based on relevant qualifications and job requirements

• Encourage employees to report concerns without fear of retaliation

• Promote transparent and participative decision-making

• Provide appropriate grievance and employee-support mechanisms

FOR CLIENT:

• Continue practicing relaxation and stress-management techniques

• Maintain professional documentation

• Focus on professional strengths and achievements

• Use appropriate organizational channels when necessary

• Maintain supportive professional relationships

• Seek further support if emotional distress persists

ORGANIZATIONAL BEHAVIOR MODEL

• Current Model: Autocratic / Management-Centred Model

• Recommended Model: Supportive System Model (inclusive, participative and transparent)

CONCLUSION

This case study highlights how gender and marital-status stereotypes in the workplace can contribute to emotional distress and concerns regarding professional security. The client experienced discomfort and anxiety after encountering a workplace remark that appeared to associate marital status with professional suitability.

Through counselling, the client gained greater emotional clarity, developed assertive communication skills and identified constructive ways of responding to workplace concerns. The case emphasizes that maintaining an inclusive organizational culture requires both individual coping strategies and organizational responsibility. Transparent policies, objective decision-making, respectful leadership and appropriate grievance mechanisms can contribute to a safer and more equitable workplace environment.

CASE STUDY – 8 NON-SYNCHRONISATION WITH TEAM MEMBERS

INTRODUCTION

Team coordination plays an important role in maintaining an efficient workflow, clear communication and productive workplace relationships. When employees are unable to align their work methods, communication patterns, priorities or expectations with those of their colleagues, difficulties in team synchronization may arise.

Non-synchronisation can occur because of differences in personality, work habits, communication preferences, unclear responsibilities or inadequate coordination. Such differences may contribute to misunderstandings, delays, frustration and reduced team cohesion. From a psychological perspective, continued coordination problems may increase workplace stress, interpersonal tension and feelings of being excluded or undervalued.

Employees who experience repeated difficulties in adjusting to team dynamics may also become less motivated and dissatisfied with their work environment. Developing effective communication, flexibility, emotional awareness and collaborative problem-solving skills can help employees adjust to diverse working styles.

This case study presents an employee experiencing difficulties in coordinating with colleagues due to differences in work approaches and communication patterns. The counselling intervention focuses on improving interpersonal communication, adaptability, emotional regulation and effective participation in team activities.

CASE DESCRIPTION

Mr. Vivek Srinivas, a 29-year-old Project Coordinator, has been employed with a mid-sized business services organisation in Hyderabad for approximately seven months. His responsibilities include coordinating project activities, following up with different departments and ensuring that assigned tasks are completed within scheduled timelines.

The client reported difficulty working in coordination with several members of his team. He described himself as someone who prefers advance planning, clearly defined responsibilities and completing assignments within agreed deadlines. However, he felt that some of his colleagues followed a more flexible approach and frequently changed their priorities according to immediate requirements.

According to the client, updates regarding task progress were sometimes shared late, which affected his ability to plan subsequent activities. He also felt that suggestions made by him during team meetings were not always given sufficient attention. Over time, he became increasingly frustrated with what he perceived as a lack of coordination.

The client acknowledged that some colleagues had started viewing him as excessively particular about deadlines and procedures. He reported that this perception created hesitation in approaching certain team members and resulted in strained workplace interactions.

As the situation continued, the client experienced increased frustration, work-related tension and a feeling of being disconnected from the team. Although he remained committed to completing his responsibilities, difficulties in adjusting to different work styles began affecting his concentration, interpersonal relationships and overall workplace satisfaction.

DEMOGRAPHIC DATA

- **Name:** Mr. Vivek Srinivas
- **Age:** 29 years
- **Gender:** Male
- **Educational Qualification:** MBA (Human Resource Management)
- **Occupation:** Project Coordinator
- **Income:** ₹46,000 per month
- **Marital Status:** Unmarried
- **Living Arrangement:** Lives with parents
- **Siblings:** One elder brother
- **Family Conflicts:** None reported
- **Physical Illness in Family:** None reported
- **Family Support:** Supportive and stable family environment

PRESENTING PROBLEM

The client reported difficulty coordinating with colleagues, which resulted in workplace frustration, communication problems and reduced efficiency in completing interconnected tasks.

Key Complaints:

- Delayed communication of work-related updates
- Differences in work methods and pace
- Feeling that his suggestions were not adequately considered
- Difficulty coordinating tasks with certain colleagues
- Occasional disagreements regarding deadlines and responsibilities
- Increased frustration and stress at the workplace

Date of Onset: Approximately 3 months ago

Precipitating Factors:

- Assignment to a new project team
- Differences in work habits among team members

- Inconsistent communication regarding task progress
- Unclear expectations regarding certain responsibilities

Duration: 3 months

Previous Counselling: None

Intensity: Mild to Moderate

INTERVIEW WITH FAMILY MEMBERS / SOCIAL RELATIONS

- **Family:** Supportive and emotionally stable
- **Friends:** Maintains regular contact with a small group of close friends
- **Colleagues:** Relationships became somewhat strained because of repeated coordination difficulties
- **Education History:** Good academic record; generally described as responsible and systematic in completing academic tasks

ONSET

The difficulty developed gradually after the client became part of a new project team in which members followed different approaches to planning, communication and task completion.

PRECIPITATING FACTORS

- Irregular communication regarding work progress
- Differences between systematic and flexible work approaches
- Perception that his suggestions were not being adequately acknowledged
- Different expectations regarding deadlines
- Increasingly cautious interactions with certain colleagues

DURATION

3 months (ongoing issue)

MENTAL STATUS EXAMINATION (MSE)

- **Appearance:** Neatly dressed and appropriately groomed
- **Behaviour:** Cooperative, attentive and mildly tense while discussing workplace concerns
- **Speech:** Clear, relevant and coherent
- **Mood:** Frustrated and mildly stressed
- **Affect:** Appropriate but somewhat constricted
- **Thought Process:** Logical and goal-directed
- **Thought Content:** Preoccupied with workplace coordination and interpersonal difficulties

- **Perception:** No perceptual abnormalities reported
- **Insight:** Good
- **Judgment:** Intact

Clinical Impression: Situational adjustment difficulty associated with interpersonal and workplace coordination stress; no major psychological disorder indicated.

COUNSELLING SESSIONS

SESSION 1

Duration: 60 minutes

Objective:

To establish rapport, understand the client's concerns and provide an opportunity for emotional expression.

Session Details:

The initial session concentrated on developing rapport and creating a non-judgmental environment in which the client could discuss his workplace experiences openly. The client described repeated difficulties in obtaining timely updates from colleagues and expressed frustration about differences in work approaches.

He reported feeling that his emphasis on planning and deadlines was sometimes interpreted negatively by team members. Emotional expression was encouraged, and his concerns were acknowledged without reinforcing negative assumptions about his colleagues.

Psychoeducation was provided regarding:

Importance of coordination in team functioning

Common communication barriers in workplace groups

Differences in individual work styles

Role of perception and assumptions in interpersonal conflicts

The client was encouraged to examine whether his expectations regarding teamwork were excessively rigid. Basic relaxation and emotional regulation strategies were also discussed to help him manage immediate workplace frustration.

Techniques Used:

Active listening

Emotional ventilation

Supportive counselling

Psychoeducation

Cognitive restructuring

Relaxation training

Client Response:

The client expressed relief after discussing his concerns and demonstrated willingness to examine his own communication patterns.

Observation:

Moderate workplace frustration was evident, along with good insight and motivation for improvement.

ACTION PLAN

Observe communication patterns within the team

Identify situations that trigger frustration

Practise relaxation techniques

Avoid making immediate negative assumptions about colleagues

Initiate brief and neutral communication with team members

SESSION 2

Duration: 60 minutes

Objective:

To develop effective communication and interpersonal skills required for better team coordination.

Session Details:

The second session focused on improving the client's communication style and ability to interact effectively with colleagues having different working preferences.

The client was guided to practise:

Communicating expectations clearly

Listening before responding

Expressing concerns without blaming others

Asking for clarification when responsibilities were unclear

Providing constructive feedback

Role-play exercises were conducted using common workplace situations such as delayed task updates, disagreement over deadlines and differences in task priorities.

The discussion also focused on collaborative approaches to problem-solving. The client was encouraged to distinguish between situations requiring firmness and situations where flexibility would be more appropriate.

Emphasis was placed on emotional intelligence, perspective-taking and adapting communication according to the needs of the situation.

Techniques Used:

Assertiveness training

Role-play

Problem-solving approach

Supportive counselling

Perspective-taking

Client Response:

The client participated actively in the role-play exercises and reported greater confidence in communicating his expectations without appearing confrontational.

Observation:

Improved participation was observed, with a reduction in emotional tension while discussing workplace interactions.

ACTION PLAN

Use assertive rather than critical communication

Participate constructively in team discussions

Ask for clarification instead of making assumptions

Develop informal rapport with colleagues

Practise flexibility when work situations require it

SESSION 3

Duration: 60 minutes

Objective:

To strengthen the client's adjustment, emotional resilience and ability to maintain effective team relationships.

Session Details:

During the third session, the client reported that communication with some colleagues had become more comfortable. He also stated that he had started providing clearer updates and was less reactive when team members followed a different work pattern.

The session focused on maintaining these positive changes through:

Adaptive workplace behaviour

Realistic expectations from team members

Emotional regulation

Perspective-taking

Constructive conflict management

The client was encouraged to understand that effective teamwork does not require every member to follow identical working methods. Instead, coordination can be improved by establishing common goals, communicating expectations and respecting reasonable differences in work styles.

Self-reflection exercises were introduced to help the client monitor his reactions, identify successful communication strategies and recognize situations where greater flexibility was required.

Techniques Used:

Supportive counselling

Reinforcement

Self-reflection

Problem-solving

Emotional regulation

Client Response:

The client appeared more balanced and reported increased confidence in handling differences within the team.

Observation:

Noticeable improvement was observed in coping, communication and willingness to adapt to different working styles.

ACTION PLAN

Continue practising effective communication

Maintain collaborative relationships

Monitor workplace stress

Use flexibility when appropriate

Give priority to shared team objectives

OVERALL OBSERVATION

The client demonstrated gradual improvement in communication, emotional regulation and adaptability. He became more aware of how differences in working styles can contribute to misunderstandings and showed greater willingness to adjust his approach. Coordination with team members improved progressively, particularly after he began using clearer communication and reducing rigid expectations.

RECOMMENDATIONS

FOR ORGANIZATION:

- Establish clear and accessible communication channels
- Define responsibilities and reporting expectations
- Encourage timely sharing of project updates
- Promote collaborative problem-solving
- Conduct periodic team-building and communication activities
- Encourage an environment where employees can clarify concerns without hesitation

FOR CLIENT:

- Continue developing effective interpersonal communication
- Maintain flexibility when working with different personalities
- Practise active listening and perspective-taking
- Develop positive professional relationships with colleagues
- Manage emotional reactions during workplace disagreements
- Focus on common team objectives rather than differences in individual work styles

ORGANIZATIONAL BEHAVIOR MODEL

- **Current Model:** Fragmented Team Dynamics
- **Recommended Model:** Collaborative Team-Based Model

CONCLUSION

This case study demonstrates how differences in communication patterns, work approaches and expectations can create difficulties in team synchronization and affect an employee's workplace experience.

Through counselling, the client developed greater awareness of his own communication patterns and learned strategies for managing differences in working styles. Improvements were observed in assertive communication, adaptability, emotional regulation and interpersonal interaction.

The case highlights that effective team functioning requires more than individual task performance. Clear communication, role clarity, mutual understanding, flexibility and organizational support are important for creating coordinated and productive workplace relationships.

CASE STUDY – 9 ADDRESSING GENDER BIAS AND POWER DYNAMICS IN THE WORKPLACE

INTRODUCTION

Gender bias and unequal use of authority are important concerns in organizational behaviour because they can influence employee morale, workplace relationships and the overall sense of psychological safety. Gender-based assumptions, particularly concerning married women, may arise from stereotypical beliefs that women with family responsibilities are less available, less committed or less willing to work extended hours.

Such assumptions can influence recruitment decisions, career opportunities and perceptions of employee commitment. When these attitudes are expressed by individuals occupying senior positions, employees may hesitate to question them because of concerns regarding authority, professional relationships or job security.

Power dynamics within organizations can therefore contribute to a culture in which inappropriate or discriminatory views remain unchallenged. From a psychological perspective, exposure to such situations may result in discomfort, stress, frustration and conflict between personal values and perceived organizational expectations.

At the same time, employees in leadership positions can contribute to positive organizational change by encouraging fairness, respectful communication and inclusive practices. This case study focuses on an employee who encounters gender-biased thinking within a hierarchical workplace and seeks ways to respond professionally while maintaining emotional balance and workplace effectiveness.

CASE DESCRIPTION

Mrs. Kavya Reddy, a 34-year-old Operations Manager, reported experiencing discomfort after a senior executive made a gender-biased comment during an internal recruitment discussion. While discussing candidates for a vacant position, the senior executive suggested giving preference to unmarried women because, according to him, they would have fewer family-related commitments and could therefore devote more time to work.

The remark created visible discomfort among some members of the meeting, although no one directly questioned the statement. The client interpreted the incident as an indication of how authority and gender stereotypes could influence workplace decisions.

Mrs. Kavya felt particularly concerned because such assumptions could affect not only recruitment decisions but also the professional opportunities available to married women within the organization. She believed that employees should be evaluated according to their qualifications, performance and ability to fulfil job requirements rather than marital status.

The client maintained positive professional relationships with most colleagues and had a good standing within the organization. However, she experienced an internal dilemma regarding whether to raise the issue formally or address it through less direct channels.

She was concerned that openly questioning a senior executive could create unnecessary tension or affect her professional relationship with senior management. At the same time, she felt that remaining completely silent would conflict with her personal values concerning fairness and equal opportunity.

The counselling process therefore focused on helping the client manage this ethical concern, understand organizational power dynamics, communicate her perspective appropriately and identify constructive ways of promoting inclusive practices.

DEMOGRAPHIC DATA

- **Name:** Mrs. Kavya Reddy
- **Age:** 34 years
- **Gender:** Female
- **Educational Qualification:** MBA (Human Resource Management)
- **Occupation:** Operations Manager
- **Income:** ₹78,000 per month
- **Marital Status:** Married
- **Location:** Hyderabad, Telangana
- **Living Arrangement:** Lives with spouse and daughter
- **Family Support:** Strong and supportive
- **Family Conflicts:** None reported

PRESENTING PROBLEM

The client expressed concern regarding gender-based assumptions made by a senior leader during a recruitment-related discussion. She wanted to understand how such concerns could be communicated appropriately without unnecessarily affecting her professional relationships or position within the organization.

Key Concerns:

- Observed gender-based bias in recruitment discussion
- Discomfort regarding stereotypical assumptions about married women
- Ethical conflict regarding whether to challenge the remark
- Concern about hierarchical power differences
- Fear of possible professional consequences
- Desire to encourage a fair and inclusive workplace

Onset: Recent, following the recruitment meeting

Duration: Current and unresolved issue

Intensity: Mild emotional distress with significant ethical concern

INTERVIEW WITH FAMILY / SOCIAL RELATIONS

- **Family:** Strong and supportive
- **Marital Relationship:** Stable and healthy
- **Friends:** Maintains supportive friendships
- **Workplace Relationships:** Generally positive and professional
- **Colleagues:** Respected by team members
- **Social Functioning:** Maintains regular professional and social interactions

MENTAL STATUS EXAMINATION (MSE)

- **Appearance:** Professionally dressed and well-groomed
- **Behaviour:** Calm, cooperative and attentive
- **Speech:** Clear, coherent and relevant
- **Mood:** Concerned and mildly apprehensive
- **Affect:** Appropriate to the situation
- **Thought Process:** Logical and organized
- **Thought Content:** Focused on fairness, workplace equality and professional consequences
- **Perception:** No abnormalities reported
- **Insight:** Good
- **Judgment:** Intact

Clinical Impression: No major psychological disorder indicated. The concern is primarily related to an ethical workplace issue, gender bias and adjustment to organizational power dynamics.

COUNSELLING SESSIONS

SESSION 1

Duration: 60 minutes

Objective:

To understand the client's concerns, facilitate emotional expression and examine the psychological impact of the workplace incident.

Session Details:

The first session focused on establishing rapport and creating a safe environment for the client to discuss the incident without fear of judgment. The client described the recruitment discussion and explained why the senior executive's statement caused discomfort.

She expressed a combination of concern, frustration and hesitation. She felt that the statement reflected a broader stereotype regarding married women and their professional commitment. At the same time, she was uncertain about the most appropriate way to respond because of the individual's senior position.

Emotional ventilation was encouraged, allowing the client to express her concerns openly. The counsellor provided psychoeducation regarding:

Gender stereotypes in workplace settings

Influence of organizational hierarchy

Power differences between employees and senior leaders

Psychological effects of silence and perceived lack of voice

Importance of professional and evidence-based communication

Cognitive reframing was used to help the client distinguish between her responsibility to uphold professional values and the need to personally confront a senior leader.

Stress-management strategies were also introduced to help her maintain emotional composure while considering possible courses of action.

Techniques Used:

Active listening

Emotional ventilation

Psychoeducation

Cognitive restructuring

Supportive counselling

Stress-management techniques

Client Response:

The client appeared relieved after discussing the situation and demonstrated greater clarity regarding the difference between reacting emotionally and responding strategically.

Observation:

The client showed good insight, strong professional values and mild apprehension regarding possible consequences.

ACTION PLAN

Reflect on possible ways of addressing the concern

Maintain professional composure

Avoid immediate emotional reactions

Observe whether similar statements or practices occur

Consider appropriate organizational channels

SESSION 2

Duration: 60 minutes

Objective:

To develop practical communication and advocacy strategies for addressing workplace bias.

Session Details:

The second session focused on identifying constructive ways through which the client could promote fair practices without unnecessarily escalating the situation.

The counsellor discussed the importance of using objective information and professional reasoning while communicating concerns. The client was encouraged to focus on job-related criteria such as qualifications, experience, performance requirements and role expectations rather than making the discussion personal.

The following strategies were explored:

Presenting objective and job-related arguments

Raising concerns through appropriate professional forums

Encouraging discussions on diversity and equal opportunity

Using assertive but respectful communication

Distinguishing between constructive disagreement and confrontation

Role-play exercises were conducted to help the client practise responses to potentially biased comments. Different scenarios were discussed, including responding during a meeting, discussing the matter privately with a supervisor and raising the concern through an appropriate organizational mechanism.

Techniques Used:

Assertiveness training

Role-play

Problem-solving

Supportive counselling

Communication training

Client Response:

The client participated actively and reported feeling more confident about expressing concerns in a calm and professional manner.

Observation:

The client demonstrated improved confidence and greater clarity regarding possible communication strategies.

ACTION PLAN

Use objective information while discussing workplace concerns

Encourage fair and transparent selection criteria

Practise assertive communication

Participate constructively in team discussions

Consider formal organizational mechanisms if the pattern continues

SESSION 3

Duration: 60 minutes

Objective:

To strengthen the client's leadership confidence, resilience and ability to promote inclusive workplace practices.

Session Details:

The third session focused on the client's role as a manager and her potential influence on workplace culture. The discussion emphasized that promoting inclusion does not always require direct confrontation and can also occur through consistent professional practices and everyday leadership behaviour.

The following areas were discussed:

Ethical leadership

Fair decision-making

Inclusive team practices

Building supportive professional relationships

Managing disagreement diplomatically

Maintaining emotional resilience

The client was encouraged to promote equal participation within her own team and ensure that work-related decisions were based on relevant professional criteria.

She was also encouraged to build constructive relationships with colleagues and identify individuals who share similar values regarding fairness and respectful workplace practices.

Techniques Used:

Supportive counselling

Reinforcement

Self-reflection

Problem-solving

Leadership development

Assertiveness training

Client Response:

The client appeared confident and solution-oriented. She expressed greater willingness to promote inclusive practices within her own area of responsibility.

Observation:

The client demonstrated good emotional regulation, leadership awareness and confidence in handling sensitive workplace concerns.

ACTION PLAN

Promote fair and inclusive practices within her team

Maintain professional communication with senior leadership

Develop supportive professional networks

Continue advocating for objective workplace practices

Monitor personal stress while dealing with organizational concerns

OVERALL OBSERVATION

The client demonstrated good psychological adjustment throughout the counselling process. Initially, she experienced discomfort and uncertainty regarding how to respond to the gender-biased statement because of the hierarchical position of the person involved.

Through counselling, she developed greater clarity regarding professional boundaries, assertive communication and constructive approaches to organizational concerns. She also recognized that promoting an inclusive workplace can be achieved through consistent leadership behaviour, objective decision-making and appropriate communication rather than through impulsive confrontation.

RECOMMENDATIONS

FOR ORGANIZATION:

- Conduct gender-sensitivity and diversity-awareness programmes
- Establish clear anti-discrimination policies and procedures
- Ensure recruitment decisions are based on job-related qualifications and requirements
- Encourage participative and respectful leadership
- Provide appropriate channels for employees to raise workplace concerns
- Promote equal professional opportunities irrespective of marital status

FOR CLIENT:

- Maintain professionalism while addressing sensitive concerns
- Use objective and evidence-based communication
- Practise assertive but respectful interaction
- Build constructive professional alliances
- Promote inclusive practices within her own team
- Maintain emotional balance when dealing with organizational disagreements

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ORGANIZATIONAL BEHAVIOR MODEL

- **Current Model:** Autocratic / Power-Based Model
- **Recommended Model:** System Model

CONCLUSION

This case study illustrates how gender stereotypes and organizational power dynamics can influence workplace decision-making and employee experiences. The senior leader's comment regarding the

perceived availability of unmarried women created an ethical concern for the client and highlighted the potential impact of gender-based assumptions within organizational settings.

The counselling intervention helped the client process her emotional response, understand the influence of hierarchy and develop practical strategies for communicating concerns professionally. She also developed greater confidence in promoting fairness and inclusive practices within her area of responsibility.

The case emphasizes the importance of objective decision-making, respectful leadership, equal opportunity and appropriate organizational mechanisms for addressing workplace bias. Individual awareness, combined with supportive organizational systems, can contribute to a more inclusive and psychologically safe work environment.

CASE STUDY – 10 INEFFECTIVE MANAGEMENT OF PEOPLE AND ORGANISATION

INTRODUCTION

Effective management of people and organizational resources is important for maintaining productivity, employee satisfaction and smooth organizational functioning. Managers are expected to coordinate employees, communicate expectations clearly, distribute responsibilities appropriately and align individual efforts with organizational objectives.

When managerial practices are inconsistent or poorly structured, employees may experience confusion, uneven workloads, communication problems and interpersonal conflicts. Difficulties such as inadequate delegation, unclear instructions, delayed decisions and limited managerial support can negatively affect both employees and organizational outcomes.

From a psychological perspective, ineffective people management may contribute to workplace stress, reduced motivation, dissatisfaction and declining employee engagement. Managers who are promoted primarily because of their technical expertise may also experience difficulty adapting to the interpersonal and leadership responsibilities of a managerial position.

This case study focuses on an employee who experienced difficulties after moving from a technical position into a managerial role. The case emphasizes the importance of leadership development, communication, delegation, conflict management and organizational support during managerial transitions.

CASE DESCRIPTION

Mr. Rahul Varma, a 36-year-old Operations Manager, has been working with a mid-sized logistics and business support organization in Hyderabad for nearly seven years. He was promoted to a managerial position approximately four months ago and was given responsibility for supervising a team of twelve employees.

Although the client had considerable technical and operational experience, he reported difficulty adjusting to the people-management responsibilities associated with his new position. He found it challenging to delegate tasks appropriately, provide corrective feedback and handle disagreements between team members.

The client reported that he often became directly involved in tasks that could have been delegated to employees. As a result, some responsibilities were not clearly assigned, while certain team members received a heavier workload than others.

Team members also expressed concerns about inconsistent instructions and changes in priorities. The client acknowledged that he sometimes communicated expectations differently to different employees

depending on the urgency of the situation. This contributed to confusion and reduced coordination within the team.

The client further reported difficulty handling interpersonal disagreements. Instead of addressing conflicts at an early stage, he sometimes postponed discussions until the issue became more serious. This affected team relationships and occasionally resulted in delays in completing assigned work.

As project deadlines were missed and complaints from team members increased, the client began experiencing pressure from senior management. He developed self-doubt regarding his managerial abilities and became increasingly worried about whether he was capable of handling the new position effectively.

The counselling intervention therefore focused on developing practical management skills, improving communication, strengthening delegation and helping the client build confidence in his leadership role.

DEMOGRAPHIC DATA

- **Name:** Mr. Rahul Varma
- **Age:** 36 years
- **Gender:** Male
- **Educational Qualification:** B.Tech (Mechanical Engineering) + MBA (Operations)
- **Occupation:** Operations Manager
- **Income:** ₹82,000 per month
- **Marital Status:** Married
- **Living Arrangement:** Lives with spouse and two children
- **Siblings:** One younger sister
- **Family Conflicts:** None reported
- **Physical Illness in Family:** None reported
- **Family Support:** Supportive family environment

PRESENTING PROBLEM

The client reported difficulty handling managerial responsibilities effectively after being promoted from an operational role to a position involving direct supervision of employees.

Key Complaints:

- Difficulty delegating responsibilities
- Uneven distribution of workload
- Lack of clarity in instructions
- Increasing disagreements among team members
- Delayed completion of assigned tasks
- Difficulty providing corrective feedback
- Work-related stress and reduced leadership confidence

Date of Onset: Approximately 4 months ago, following promotion

Precipitating Factors:

- Transition from technical/operational work to people management
- Limited formal leadership training
- Increased responsibility for team performance
- Difficulty adapting to supervisory responsibilities

Duration: 4 months

Previous Counselling: None

Intensity: Moderate

INTERVIEW WITH FAMILY MEMBERS / SOCIAL RELATIONS

- **Family:** Supportive; spouse noticed an increase in work-related tension
- **Friends:** Social interaction has reduced somewhat because of increased workload
- **Colleagues:** Relationships with some team members became strained
- **Education History:** Strong academic and technical background with limited previous experience in formal people management
- **Social Functioning:** Generally maintained, although workplace stress affected his availability for social activities

ONSET

The difficulties developed gradually after the client was promoted to a managerial position and became responsible for supervising a larger team.

PRECIPITATING FACTORS

- Limited preparation for the managerial role
- Difficulty delegating responsibilities
- Inconsistent communication
- Unclear expectations among team members
- Limited experience in handling workplace conflicts
- Increased pressure for team-level results

DURATION

4 months (ongoing issue)

MENTAL STATUS EXAMINATION (MSE)

- **Appearance:** Well-groomed and professionally dressed

- **Behaviour:** Cooperative and attentive, with mild signs of anxiety
- **Speech:** Clear and normal in rate and volume
- **Mood:** Worried and stressed
- **Affect:** Mildly constricted but appropriate
- **Thought Process:** Logical and organized
- **Thought Content:** Preoccupied with managerial responsibilities and team performance
- **Perception:** No abnormalities reported
- **Insight:** Good
- **Judgment:** Intact

Clinical Impression: Situational work-related stress associated with difficulties in managerial adjustment; no major psychological disorder indicated.

COUNSELLING SESSIONS

SESSION 1

Duration: 60 minutes

Objective:

To understand the client's difficulties in managing employees and provide emotional support during his transition into the managerial role.

Session Details:

The first session focused on rapport building and understanding the client's experience following his promotion. The client described feeling overwhelmed by the responsibility of supervising multiple employees and expressed concern that his previous technical strengths had not adequately prepared him for people-management responsibilities.

He reported difficulty deciding which tasks should be delegated and which required his direct involvement. He also expressed concern about disagreements between team members and his uncertainty regarding how to address them effectively.

Emotional ventilation was encouraged so that the client could express his concerns and apprehensions openly. Psychoeducation was provided regarding:

Changing responsibilities during the transition to management

Difference between technical expertise and managerial effectiveness

Importance of delegation

Clear communication of expectations

Role of a manager in supporting employee performance

The client was also introduced to basic stress-management techniques to reduce work-related tension and improve emotional control.

Techniques Used:

Active listening

Emotional ventilation

Psychoeducation

Supportive counselling

Stress-management training

Client Response:

The client felt understood and acknowledged that his difficulties were partly related to the transition from an individual contributor role to people management. He expressed willingness to develop new managerial skills.

Observation:

Moderate workplace stress was evident, but the client demonstrated good insight and motivation for improvement.

ACTION PLAN

Identify major managerial challenges

Observe team members' strengths and work patterns

Identify tasks suitable for delegation

Practise basic stress-management techniques

Maintain a record of recurring team issues

SESSION 2

Duration: 60 minutes

Objective:

To strengthen leadership, delegation, communication and conflict-management skills.

Session Details:

The second session focused on practical management skills that could help the client improve team functioning.

The client was guided in:

Assigning responsibilities according to employee strengths

Communicating expectations in specific terms

Setting realistic deadlines

Providing constructive feedback

Addressing disagreements at an early stage

Monitoring progress without excessive interference

The counsellor introduced a simple delegation framework in which the client would clarify the task, expected outcome, deadline and level of responsibility before assigning work.

Assertiveness training was also used to help the client communicate expectations without becoming either overly controlling or excessively passive.

Role-play situations were discussed involving an employee missing a deadline, two employees disagreeing about task ownership and a team member requiring performance feedback.

Time-management and planning strategies were introduced to help the client shift from reactive management toward more structured planning.

Techniques Used:

Leadership skills training

Assertiveness training

Role-play

Problem-solving

Communication skills training

Time-management strategies

Client Response:

The client became more confident while practising delegation and communication techniques and expressed motivation to apply the strategies within his team.

Observation:

Greater clarity was observed regarding managerial responsibilities, along with reduced anxiety while discussing difficult workplace situations.

ACTION PLAN

Delegate tasks according to employee capability

Communicate responsibilities clearly

Address interpersonal conflicts at an early stage

Conduct brief progress reviews

Plan important team activities in advance

SESSION 3

Duration: 60 minutes

Objective:

To consolidate managerial skills and promote sustainable improvement in team functioning.

Session Details:

During the third session, the client reported better coordination within the team and fewer misunderstandings regarding task responsibilities. He stated that employees had begun responding more positively after he started providing clearer instructions and distributing responsibilities more systematically.

The session focused on:

Reinforcing effective leadership behaviours

Building trust with team members

Improving decision-making

Encouraging employee participation

Maintaining appropriate managerial boundaries

Developing confidence as a people manager

The client was encouraged to adopt a participative management approach by seeking relevant input from team members while retaining responsibility for final decisions.

Self-reflection exercises were introduced to help him evaluate his managerial behaviour and identify situations in which he could improve his communication, delegation or conflict-management approach.

Techniques Used:

Supportive counselling

Positive reinforcement

Leadership development

Self-reflection

Problem-solving

Client Response:

The client appeared more confident and reported greater comfort in handling team responsibilities.

Observation:

Improvement was observed in leadership confidence, communication and organization of team activities.

ACTION PLAN

Continue using structured delegation

Maintain open communication with employees

Review team performance regularly

Encourage employee participation

Address conflicts constructively

Continue self-evaluation of leadership behaviour

OVERALL OBSERVATION

The client demonstrated progressive improvement in managerial confidence, communication and delegation skills. He became more comfortable distributing responsibilities rather than attempting to personally handle most tasks.

The team coordination difficulties also reduced as the client adopted clearer communication and more structured planning. His stress levels appeared to decrease as he developed greater confidence in handling managerial responsibilities.

RECOMMENDATIONS

FOR ORGANIZATION:

- Provide structured leadership-development programmes for newly promoted managers
- Offer mentoring or supervisory support during managerial transitions
- Define managerial roles and responsibilities clearly
- Encourage participative management practices

- Provide training in communication and conflict resolution
- Promote continuous employee and manager development

FOR CLIENT:

- Continue developing people-management skills
- Delegate responsibilities according to employee strengths
- Maintain clear and consistent communication
- Address conflicts before they escalate
- Conduct regular team discussions
- Use structured planning and time-management practices
- Practise stress-management techniques regularly
- Seek feedback from team members and senior managers

ORGANIZATIONAL BEHAVIOR MODEL

- **Current Model:** Weak Management / Role Ambiguity Model
- **Recommended Model:** Participative Leadership Model

CONCLUSION

This case study highlights the difficulties that can arise when an employee transitions from a technically oriented position to a managerial role without adequate preparation for people-management responsibilities.

The client initially experienced difficulties with delegation, communication, conflict resolution and team coordination, which contributed to workplace stress and reduced confidence. Through counselling, leadership development and practical skill-building, he developed greater awareness of effective managerial practices.

Improvement was observed in his ability to delegate tasks, communicate expectations, manage interpersonal issues and involve employees in team processes. The case emphasizes that effective management requires not only technical competence but also interpersonal skills, leadership development, communication and organizational support.

Providing appropriate training and guidance to newly promoted managers can help organizations improve team functioning while reducing the stress associated with managerial transitions.

APPENDIX-X

RECEIVING SLIP

This is to acknowledge that **Mr. Gugulothu Mukesh Varma** Enrollment No. **2501560721** of MAPC (2nd Year) has submitted the Internship Report at the Study Centre: **Nizam college** and Regional Centre: **Hyderabad**

Date:

Signature (with stamp)

Received by